

Amphibian facts

The first amphibians evolved from fish and moved on to land more than 300 million years ago. Today, most amphibians move between land and water. They are found throughout the world, and most commonly in moist, freshwater habitats like woodlands and rainforests.

WHAT IS AN AMPHIBIAN?



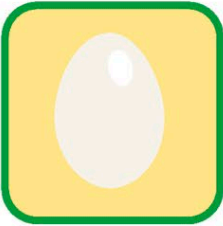
Vertebrates

Like their fish ancestors, all amphibians have an internal skeleton made of bone.



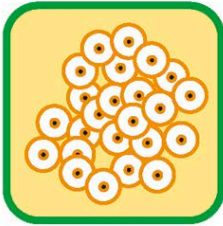
Cold-blooded

The body temperature of amphibians fluctuates with that of the air and water around them.



Lay eggs

Most amphibians lay soft eggs, but some give birth to live young.



Aquatic young

The young hatch and stay for a time as tadpoles in water, eventually turning into amphibious adults.



Moist skin

Water passes through an amphibian's thin, moist skin, allowing it to breathe under water.

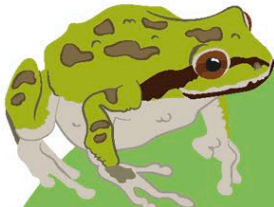
AMPHIBIAN TYPES

ESTIMATED NUMBER OF AMPHIBIAN SPECIES:

8,251

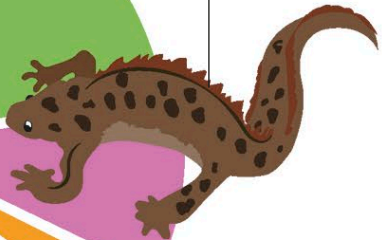
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Salamanders and newts are biologically very similar animals. However, salamanders spend more time on land, while newts spend more time in water when breeding



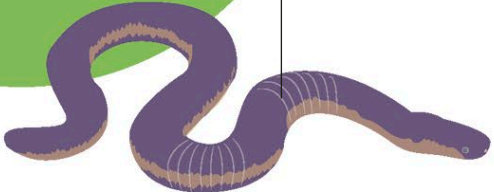
7,280

Frogs and toads are the largest group of amphibians. Scientifically, frogs and toads belong to the same animal group, but frogs typically have smoother skin.



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Caecilians are small, snakelike amphibians with no limbs and tentacles on their heads. They spend most of their lives underground, eating insects and worms. Some species live in water and have a tail fin for swimming.



EXTREME HABITATS

These unique amphibians can withstand the toughest conditions, from icy winters to the darkest caves.



Water-holding frogs have adapted to harsh Australian deserts. They burrow underground and form a waxy cocoon from layers of skin, which retains moisture necessary for survival.



Olms are blind, aquatic salamanders that live in the caves of Slovenia and Croatia. They have excellent smell and hearing, which is helpful when foraging for food, such as snails.



Crab-eating frogs are able to tolerate saltier habitats than other amphibians. Native to Southeast Asia, this frog mainly eats insects, but it also preys on crabs, hence its name.

NEARLY 50% OF ALL **AMPHIBIANS** ARE **THREATENED**, DUE TO **WATER POLLUTION**, **HABITAT DESTRUCTION**, AND THE INTRODUCTION OF **INVASIVE SPECIES**.

